Mr. Arul did not tell Sister Mary that he took one tablet already. Patient had 2 tablets instead of one tablet. It comes under **Negligence and Malpractice**, which is one of legal issue. This is due to the poor communication between the sisters. Even if not able to communicate they should have entered in the patient chart. **Patient chart** is an ideal way of communicating the information to the next person. Since Sister Lucy did not record or enter in the chart, Mr. Arul had two tablets. This incident tells about the importance of recording and report.

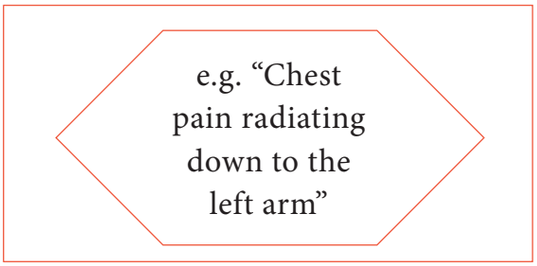
13.4 Principles of Documentation

Accuracy in Charting

- Be specific and definite in using words or phrases that convey the meaning you wish expressed
- Words that have ambiguous meanings and slang should not be used in charting
- Chart objective facts, not your interpretations or opinions

✓	Ate 50% of the food served.	
X	Ate with poor appetite.	
✓	Refused medications.	
X	Uncooperative.	KEY;
✓	Seen crying.	✓ = correct
X	Depressed.	X = Wrong

Place the complaint of the client in quotation marks to indicate that it is his statement.



Date and time

Document the date and time of each recording.

Correct spelling

It is essential for accuracy in recording.

Appropriateness

Record only information that pertains to the client's health problems and care.

Legal Protection

Accurate complete documentation will give legal protection to the nurse other health care professional of the institution and the client.

Accuracy

Client's name and identification data must be written on each page of the clients records and entries must be accurate.

Completeness

Document all information necessary to explain the events in a shift. Anyone reading the document should have a clear picture of what took place.

Brief

Only standard medical and nursing terminology and community recognized abbreviations and symbols should be used.

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